Inferring Coercions for Monadic Programming

This paper shows how to use subtyping to infer uses of the basic monad operations.

CCS Concepts: • **Software and its engineering** → **Functional languages**; *Recursion.*

Additional Key Words and Phrases: strong functional programming, type-based termination, Mendler-style recursion

ACM Reference Format:
. 2026. Inferring Coercions for Monadic Programming. *J. ACM* 37, 4, Article 111 (August 2026), 2 pages. https://doi.org/XXXXXXX.XXXXXXX

1 INTRODUCTION

The basic subtyping axioms for applicatives are:

$$\frac{}{\mathsf{L}\ (T_1 \to T_2) <: \mathsf{L}\ T_1 \to \mathsf{L} T_2}\ \mathit{seq} \qquad \frac{}{T <: \mathsf{L}\ T}\ \mathit{pure}$$

[1]

2 A DECISION PROCEDURE

Consider this example subtyping:

$$\mathsf{N} \to \mathsf{N} \quad <: \quad \mathsf{L}\ \mathsf{N} \to \mathsf{L}\ (\mathsf{L}\ \mathsf{N})$$

This is valid for applicatives, because we may first use `fmap` (which follows from `pure` and `seq`) to add L to the domain and codomain parts of the type, and then we may use function subtyping to expose the codomain part, and add an extra L with `pure`. So the coercion of $f : \mathsf{N} \to \mathsf{N}$ would be

$$\mathit{pure} \cdot (\mathit{fmap}\ f)$$

Note that with our current set of coercions, we cannot apply the function subtyping rule at the beginning, because we do not have (contravariantly) $\mathsf{L}\ \mathsf{N} <: \mathsf{N}$. The challenge of admissibility of transitivity is to derive coercions that do not use composition. So we need some form of function subtyping rule that takes occurrences of L in the domain part of the upper bound type (T_2 in $T_1 <: T_2$) into account. To do this, we adopt a new function subtyping rule that keeps track of how many applications of the functor would need to be inserted.

We work with types T and T' in the syntax shown in Figure 1. We use N as a base type (it could be the natural numbers), and L as an example covariant functor (like the list datatype). The figure also gives the syntax for *modes* θ, which play an important role in our decision procedure for subtyping. The mode τ means a top-level position in the types, while a means any position. Figure 2 presents that procedure in the form of a proof system for deriving judgments of the form $(k)\ T <:^{\theta} T'$, where $k \in \mathbb{N}$. The semantics of this judgment is:

- $(k)\ T <:^{a} T'$ means that $\mathsf{L}^k\ T <: T'$, and

Author's address:

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ACM 0004-5411/2026/8-ART111
https://doi.org/XXXXXXX.XXXXXXX

$$\begin{array}{llll} \textit{Types} & S, T & ::= & \mathsf{N} \mid \mathsf{L}\, T \mid T \to T' \\ \textit{Modes} & \theta & ::= & a \mid \tau \end{array}$$

Fig. 1. Syntax of types

$$\frac{}{(0)\ \mathsf{N} <:^a \mathsf{N}}\ \textit{refl} \qquad \frac{(j)\ T_1' <:^\tau T_1 \quad (k)\ T_2 <:^a T_2' \quad i \le j \le k}{(i)\ T_1 \to T_2 <:^a T_1' \to T_2'}\ \textit{fun}$$

$$\frac{(k)\ T <:^\tau T'}{(k+1)\ \mathsf{L}\, T <:^\tau T'}\ \textit{seq-dom} \qquad \frac{(0)\ T <:^a T'}{(0)\ T <:^\tau T'}\ \textit{reset}$$

$$\frac{(k+1)\ T <:^a T_1 \to T_2}{(k)\ \mathsf{L}\, T <:^a T_1 \to T_2}\ \textit{seq-cod} \qquad \frac{(k)\ T <:^\theta T'}{(k)\ \mathsf{L}\, T <:^\theta \mathsf{L}\, T'}\ \textit{cov}$$

$$\frac{(k)\ T <:^a T'}{(k+1)\ T <:^a \mathsf{L}\, T'}\ \textit{pure}$$

Fig. 2. Proposed rules for applicatives

Fig. 3. Example derivation

- $(k)\ \mathsf{L}^k\ T <:^\tau T'$ means that $T <: T'$.

An example derivation is shown in Figure 3.

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